

Codebook: Card & Krueger (1994)
NJ-PA Fast-Food Employment Survey (`public.dat`)

Overview

The raw file `public.dat` contains **410 observations** (one row per store), each with **46 whitespace-delimited fields**. Missing values are coded as a literal period (.). Each row contains data from *both* survey waves: Wave 1 (February–March 1992, pre minimum-wage increase) and Wave 2 (November–December 1992, post increase). Wave-2 variables share the same name as their Wave-1 counterpart with a trailing 2 (e.g. `EMPFT` vs. `EMPFT2`).

Key derived variable: FTE employment

Full-time-equivalent employment, as defined in Card & Krueger (1994, footnote 8):

$$\text{FTE} = \text{EMPFT} + \text{NMGRS} + 0.5 \times \text{EMPPT}$$

Variable List

Name	Start	End	Description
SHEET	1	3	Store ID (unique sheet number)
CHAIN	5	5	Chain: 1=Burger King, 2=KFC, 3=Roy Rogers, 4=Wendy's
CO_OWNED	7	7	1 if company-owned (vs. franchisee-owned)
STATE	9	9	1 if New Jersey, 0 if Pennsylvania
SOUTHJ	11	11	1 if southern NJ
CENTRALJ	13	13	1 if central NJ
NORTHJ	15	15	1 if northern NJ
PA1	17	17	1 if PA, northeast suburbs of Philadelphia
PA2	19	19	1 if PA, Easton area
SHORE	21	21	1 if on the NJ shore
<i>Wave 1 (first interview)</i>			
NCALLS	23	24	Number of call-backs
EMPFT	26	30	# full-time employees
EMPPT	32	36	# part-time employees
NMGRS	38	42	# managers / assistant managers
WAGE_ST	44	48	Starting wage (\$/hr)
INCTIME	50	54	Months to usual first raise
FIRSTINC	56	60	Usual amount of first raise (\$/hr)
BONUS	62	62	1 if cash bounty offered for new workers

Name	Start	End	Description
PCTAFF	64	68	% of employees affected by new minimum wage
MEALS	70	70	Meal program: 0=none, 1=free, 2=reduced price, 3=both
OPEN	72	76	Hour of opening
HRSOPEN	78	82	Number of hours open per day
PSODA	84	88	Price of medium soda (incl. tax)
PFRY	90	94	Price of small fries (incl. tax)
PENTREE	96	100	Price of entrée (incl. tax)
NREGS	102	103	Number of cash registers in store
NREGS11	105	106	Number of registers open at 11:00 am
<i>Wave 2 (second interview)</i>			
TYPE2	108	108	Interview type: 1=phone, 2=personal
STATUS2	110	110	Store status (see codes below)
DATE2	112	117	Date of second interview (MMDDYY)
NCALLS2	119	120	Number of call-backs
EMPFT2	122	126	# full-time employees
EMPPT2	128	132	# part-time employees
NMGRS2	134	138	# managers / assistant managers
WAGE_ST2	140	144	Starting wage (\$/hr)
INCTIME2	146	150	Months to usual first raise
FIRSTIN2	152	156	Usual amount of first raise (\$/hr)
SPECIAL2	158	158	1 if special program for new workers
MEALS2	160	160	Meal program code (see codes below)
OPEN2R	162	166	Hour of opening
HRSOPEN2	168	172	Number of hours open per day
PSODA2	174	178	Price of medium soda (incl. tax)
PFRY2	180	184	Price of small fries (incl. tax)
PENTREE2	186	190	Price of entrée (incl. tax)
NREGS2	192	193	Number of cash registers in store
NREGS112	195	196	Number of registers open at 11:00 am

Codes

Meal program (MEALS / MEALS2)

- 0 = none
- 1 = free meals
- 2 = reduced-price meals
- 3 = both free and reduced-price meals

Second-interview status (STATUS2)

- 0 = refused second interview ($n = 1$)
- 1 = answered second interview ($n = 399$)

- 2 = closed for renovations ($n = 2$)
- 3 = closed permanently ($n = 6$)
- 4 = closed for highway construction ($n = 1$)
- 5 = closed due to mall fire ($n = 1$)

Source: Card, D. and Krueger, A.B. (1994). "Minimum Wages and Employment: A Case Study of the Fast-Food Industry in New Jersey and Pennsylvania." American Economic Review, 84(4), 772–793.